

Michael Alexander – Game Designer

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Summary

Game Designer with 9+ years of experience at Dovetail Games, specialising in mission/scenario design and vehicle-based simulation. Focused on player onboarding, exciting and authentic gameplay experiences, and data-driven balancing using Unreal Engine Blueprints and proprietary tools. Passionate about simulation games, but also management games and open-world adventures. Looking to broaden my knowledge and skills in other genres.

Professional Experience

Dovetail Games – Game Designer | Jan 2019 - Present

- Designed and implemented 30+ gameplay scenarios and tutorials for Train Sim World, focusing on realistic railway operations, player onboarding, and progressive difficulty.
- Designed scenarios based on real-world railway operations, translating complex timetables and signalling systems into accessible gameplay experiences.
- Designed races and boss challenges for Metro Rivals, focusing on AI behaviour tuning, timing windows, damage control, and progression pacing.
- Balanced difficulty and progression using player feedback, QA data, and iteration cycles, improving onboarding clarity and reducing early-player friction.
- Implemented mission logic and gameplay scripting using Unreal Engine 4 & 5 Blueprints, working within proprietary tool constraints to deliver stable, shippable content.
- Acted as feature owner for content, driving implementation from concept through iteration to final release.
- Iterated on gameplay using QA feedback, telemetry, and internal playtests to refine difficulty curves and player guidance.

Dovetail Games – QA Sign-Off Tester | 2017 – 2019

- Identifying and reproducing issues, logging them in the Jira ticketing systems.
- Creating and editing test cases for various areas of gameplay features.
- Regularly communicating with development and production, specifically if there are blockers.

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Projects

Metro Rivals (unreleased project) | Games Designer

- Challenges, Multiplayer Races, Single-Player Progression

Thomas and Friends: Wonders of Sodor | James DLC | Game Designer

- Narrative Design, Scenarios, Cutscenes

TSW 2, TSW 3, TSW 4, TSW 5, TSW 6 | Various DLCs | Game Designer

- Tutorials, Scenarios, Service Timetable Simulations

Core Design Skills

- Tutorial / Mission / Scenario Design
- Simulation Systems Design
- Vehicle Gameplay & Onboarding
- Progression & Difficulty Balancing

Technical Skills

- Unreal Engine 4 & 5 (Blueprints)
- Visual Scripting & Gameplay Implementation
- Data-Driven Balancing
- Design Documentation
- Visual Scripting
- Vehicle Simulation

Hobbies

My passion for video games is deeply rooted from the classics, leading me have an active interest in arcades, games like Outrun, Time Crisis, Crazy Taxi and House of the Dead were some of my favourites to pass the time. I strive to keep that kind of experience alive, collecting retro and classic games, while also offering my knowledge and experience in maintaining classic arcade machines. I'm also a fan of motorsport. I always find time at the weekends to watch F1 and I still hold out on WRC (though the older rallying is closer to my heart). I also have interests in anything historical, visiting Vintage Steam rallies and Heritage Railways.

Education

The University of Bolton - HND Games Design

Lytham St. Annes High School & Technology College - GCSEs & A-Levels

(Media Studies, Programming, Graphics & Animation)